Mom's Application Records in One Place

What you have, where it is, what dates it covers and who holds it.

The bank statements are in Mom's desk, the insurance policy is in a box at your brother's, and nobody is sure where the deed is.

This page doesn't ask you to understand any of it. It asks where each record is, what dates it covers, and who has it.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	DATES IT COVERS	WHO HAS IT
Identity and residency papers: Social Security card, birth certificate, something showing her address			
Social Security and other income records			
Bank statements, for each account			
Investment and retirement account statements			
Insurance policies, or a recent statement for each			
Real-estate papers: deed, tax bill, mortgage or loan papers			
Trust or annuity documents, if she has either			
Paperwork about any transfers of money or property, if there have been any			
Her spouse's records, if she is married			
Care and facility paperwork: admission papers, recent bills			
Letters from the Medicaid agency, and copies of anything already sent			

What's missing, and who will look for it

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each, and where you've already looked.

FOR EXAMPLE The deed to the house. Not in Mom's desk. David will go through the box at his place this weekend.

How to use it

- For statements, write the first and last month you have. If a month in between is missing, note which one.
- Don't rewrite or summarize a record here, and leave account numbers and Social Security numbers off the page. Just say where each thing is.
- Which records are needed, and for which dates, depends on the state. Bring this page to your Medicaid planner and ask.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any statement, policy, deed or letter means, and it doesn't say which records Mom's application needs. That depends on her state and her situation, and it is a question for your Medicaid planner. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where each record is, what dates it covers and which ones nobody has found yet. The planning interview uses what you've collected: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report to bring, along with this page, to any conversation about paying for Mom's care.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Several rows follow the lists of personal and financial papers that the National Institute on Aging and the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau suggest keeping in one place, and USA.gov's note that what a state asks for depends on the state. The rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. National Institute on Aging, Getting Your Affairs in Order Checklist: Documents to Prepare for the Future
2. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Planning for diminished capacity and illness
3. USA.gov, How to apply for Medicaid and CHIP